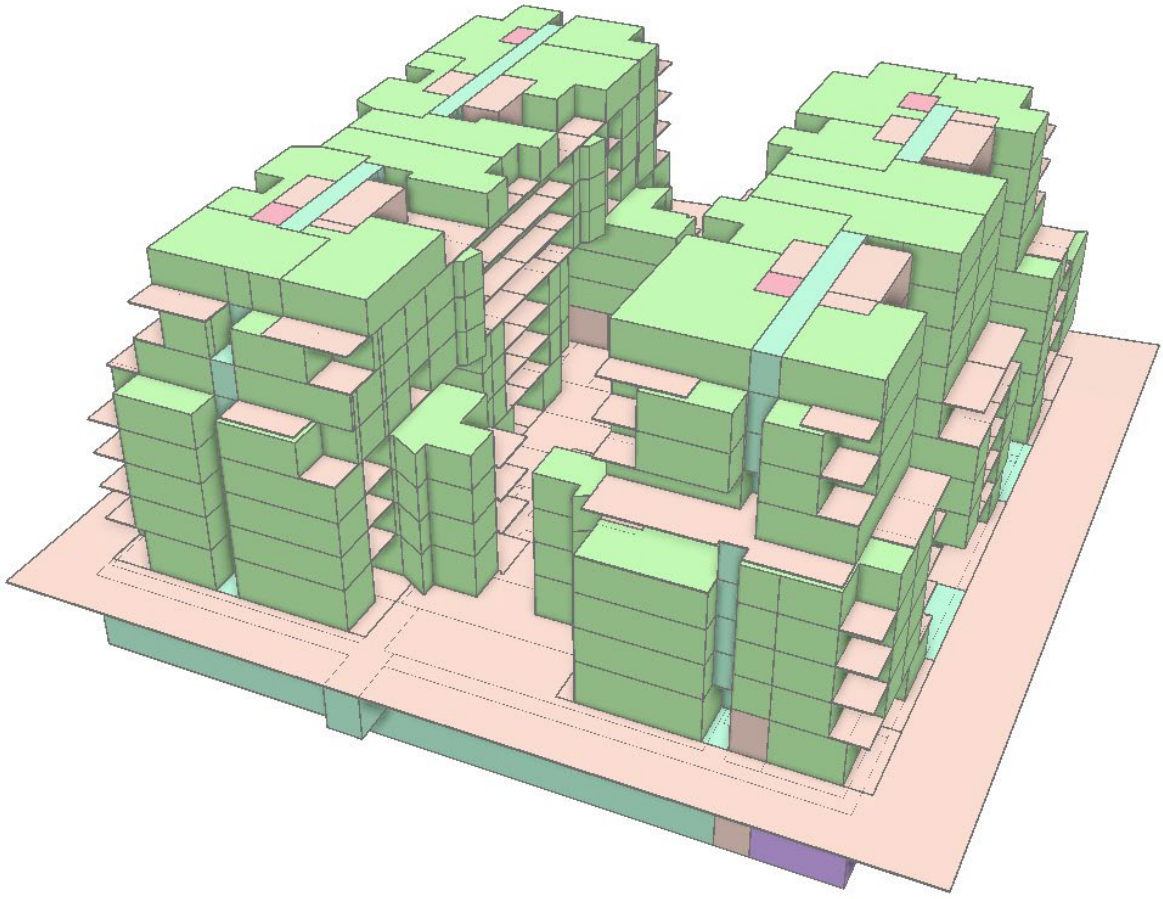
CITY OF SYDNEY

Housing Audit

June 2025



Housing Audit

The City of Sydney acknowledges the Gadigal of the Eora Nation as the Traditional Custodians of our local area.

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Background

The City of Sydney Housing Data Collection Framework provides a comprehensive method for the audit of all housing (building) and dwelling stock in the local area. This provides an estimate of all types of residential buildings, dwelling structure, and dwelling tenure. The audit of the housing and dwelling stock in the City of Sydney local area will be reported annually at the end of each financial year.

The Housing Audit's data is sourced from the City of Sydney Floor Space and Employment Survey (the most recent Survey was undertaken in 2022/23). Annual updates are augmented by information collected from monitoring of development statistics and changes to ownership patterns, and data gathered from housing providers. The data considers both additions (new dwellings) and subtractions (demolished dwellings, change of use) to obtain net increase and end of year totals for housing and dwellings.

The City of Sydney local area has undergone a rapid increase in dwelling stock over the past decade, with more new dwellings due for completion in both the near and medium terms. There are currently 14,333 private dwellings and 3,579 non-private dwellings in the City's development pipeline, due for completion over the next five years. The Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) Estimated Resident Population (ERP) for the City of Sydney local area at June 2024 was 237,238 (*Australian Bureau of Statistics (2023-24), Regional population, ABS Website, accessed 11 August 2025*). The residential population increased by 6,151 between June 2023 and June 2024.

The City's Community Strategic Plan (*Sustainable Sydney 2030-2050 Continuing the Vision*) contains 10 strategic directions aimed at delivering a city the community wants by 2036. Strategic Direction 10 – Housing for all – aims for "… a city where everyone has a home. Social, affordable, and supported housing is available for those who need it. High-quality housing is available for everyone".

In the City's Community Strategic Plan, Target 6 states that by 2036:

"**By 2036 there will be at least 156,000 private dwellings** and 17,500 non-private dwellings that include boarding houses and student accommodation. Of the private dwellings, **7.5% will be social housing and 7.5% will be affordable rental and diverse housing** with this proportion maintained into the future."

The figures quoted in the Community Strategic Plan relate to private and non-private dwellings as defined by the ABS. Private dwellings include social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing, and privately owned or rented housing. The term non-private dwelling applies to boarding houses (Class 1B and Class 3 – also known as traditional and new generation), student accommodation and residential care services (such as aged-care facilities). The Housing Audit reports on newer dwelling types including Build-to-Rent (private dwellings), Co-Living (non-private dwellings (Class 3)), and Diverse Housing (private or non-private dwellings).

The June 2025 Housing Audit provides a comprehensive data set for the assessment of all housing stock and housing types in the city.

The Housing Audit reports annually on the following:

- The city's current dwelling stock (buildings and dwellings)
  - private dwellings
  - non-private dwellings
- number of dwellings by Village area
- building structure
- dwelling structure including net annual increase
- dwelling tenure (type) including net annual increase

The 2025 Housing Audit also includes information on median income for City residents (Census data) and median rents (Department of Communities and Justice (formerly Housing) data).

Housing at June 2025

Building and dwelling stock

As of June 2025, it is estimated that there were 22,173 buildings in the City of Sydney local area that contain residential dwellings (either private or non-private dwellings).

Within these buildings there were a total of 142,866 residential dwellings counted.

There were 125,720 private dwellings (private ownership and rental dwellings, social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing, build-to-rent).

There were 17,146 non-private dwellings (boarding house rooms, co-living units, student accommodation rooms, residential care services).

Dwelling location, totals and net change, year to June 2025

The following tables show the numbers of private, non-private and total dwellings at June 2024 and June 2025, with net change in dwellings and percentage change in dwellings over the financial year.

Table 1. Private dwellings at 30 June 2025 by village

Village	Private Dwellings (private ownership and rental dwellings, social (including public) housing, affordable and rental housing), build-to-rent			
	Jun-24	Jun-25	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	6,346	7,315	969	15.3%
Chinatown & CBD South	9,495	9,729	234	2.5%
Crown & Baptist Streets	13,081	13,080	-1	0.0%
Glebe Point Road	12,443	12,444	1	0.0%
Green Square and City South	23,844	24,173	329	1.4%
Harris Street	9,157	9,157	0	0.0%
King Street	10,794	10,957	163	1.5%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	13,088	13,074	-14	-0.1%
Oxford Street	11,065	11,071	6	0.1%
Redfern Street	14,697	14,720	23	0.2%
City of Sydney local area	**124,010**	**125,720**	**1,710**	**1.4%**

Table 2. Non-private dwellings at 30 June 2025 by village

Village	Non-private Dwellings (boarding house rooms, co-living, student accommodation rooms, residential care services)			
	Jun-24	Jun-25	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	17	17	0	0.0%
Chinatown & CBD South	1,449	1,370	-79	-5.5%
Crown & Baptist Streets	1,132	1,123	-9	-0.8%
Glebe Point Road	2,001	2,002	1	0.0%
Green Square and City South	19	88	69	363.2%
Harris Street	865	865	0	0.0%
King Street	3,823	3,850	27	0.7%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	380	380	0	0.0%
Oxford Street	1,133	1,133	0	0.0%
Redfern Street	5,547	6,318	771	13.9%
City of Sydney local area	**16,366**	**17,146**	**780**	**4.8%**

Table 3. Total dwellings (private and non-private) at 30 June 2025 by village

Village	Total Dwellings			
	Jun-24	Jun-25	Change	% Change
CBD and Harbour	6,363	7,332	969	15.2%
Chinatown & CBD South	10,944	11,099	155	1.4%
Crown & Baptist Streets	14,213	14,203	-10	-0.1%
Glebe Point Road	14,444	14,446	2	0.0%
Green Square and City South	23,863	24,261	398	1.7%
Harris Street	10,022	10,022	0	0.0%
King Street	14,617	14,807	190	1.3%
Macleay St & Woolloomooloo	13,468	13,454	-14	-0.1%
Oxford Street	12,198	12,204	6	0.0%
Redfern Street	20,244	21,038	794	3.9%
City of Sydney local area	**140,376**	**142,866**	**2,490**	**1.8%**

There was a net increase of 1,710 private dwellings and 780 non-private dwellings (2,490 total dwellings) in the city in the past year. Net increase includes the addition of completed dwellings and the subtraction of demolished or replacement dwellings. CBD and Harbour had both the highest net and proportional growth over the past year, with 969 additional dwellings and a 15.2% increase.

The highest number of private dwellings was in the Green Square and City South village (24,261). 56.7% of the net private dwelling increase for 2024/25 occurred in the CBD and Harbour village.

Redfern Street village had the highest number of non-private dwellings (6,318). Non-private dwellings increased by 4.8% between June 2024 and June 2025, up to 17,146.

The dwelling targets for the Community Strategic Plan are for the city to have at least 156,000 (private) dwellings and 17,500 non-private dwellings by 2036. The baseline figures (June 2021) were 121,725 private dwellings and 15,127 non-private dwellings. The targets require an additional 34,275 private dwellings at an average of 2,285 per annum, and 2,373 non-private dwellings at an average of 158 per annum between 2021 and 2036.

By June 2025 there were 125,720 private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, or 80.6% of the total private dwelling target for 2036. By June 2025 there were 17,146 non-private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, or 98.0% of the total non-private dwelling target for 2036.

There are 14,333 private dwellings and 3,579 non-private dwellings in the city's development pipeline (developments lodged, approved, or commenced construction).

Building structure

Approximately 97.7% of the building stock (22,173 total buildings) in the City of Sydney local area falls into four main types:

– terrace, town house and semi-detached buildings (78.0%)

– multi-storey apartment buildings (10.0%)

– separate (detached) houses (6.3%), and

– buildings with dwellings above shops (3.4%).

The other 2.3% of building stock comprises a mix of buildings containing residential care services, boarding house accommodation, student accommodation, or other dwelling types.

Dwelling structure

Of the 125,720 private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area at June 2025, 20,199 dwellings were terrace houses, comprising 16.1% of all private dwellings. A further 101,740 dwellings were in multi-storey apartment buildings, comprising 81.7% of all private dwellings.

There were also 1,479 separate (detached) dwellings and 1,005 dwellings located above shops in the City of Sydney local area. These comprised 1.2% and 0.8% of total private dwellings respectively.

There were 2,295 attached/granny flats included in the separate (detached) house (36), terrace, town house and semi-detached building (249), and buildings with dwellings above shops (10) totals.

The other 310 private dwellings include caretaker's and manager's flats, converted flats or other dwellings.

Additionally, there were 17,146 non-private dwellings in the City of Sydney local area, including 3,458 boarding house rooms (19.4% of non-private dwellings), 12,924 student accommodation rooms (75.4% of non-private dwellings), and 764 other dwellings (4.5% of non-private dwellings). In 2024/25 there was a net increase of 804 student accommodation rooms. There was a net loss of 24 boarding house rooms.

During the 2024/25 financial year, there was a net increase of 2,490 total dwellings across the local area (1.8% growth). The net dwelling stock increased by 1,710 private dwellings (1.4%) and 780 non-private dwellings (4.8%).

The average net total dwelling increase over the past ten years was 3,115 dwellings per annum (31,154 total dwellings). This consisted of an average 2,440 private dwellings per annum (24,399 dwellings) and 676 non-private dwellings per annum (6,755 dwellings).

Figure 1 on the following page shows the change in total dwelling numbers between 2015 and 2025 for small areas within the City of Sydney local area. The main growth areas have been around Green Square and Ashmore Estate in the southern half of the city; around Redfern Station where significant student accommodation has been built; Darling Square with apartments and student housing; and Barangaroo with nearly 850 apartments completed in the last year.

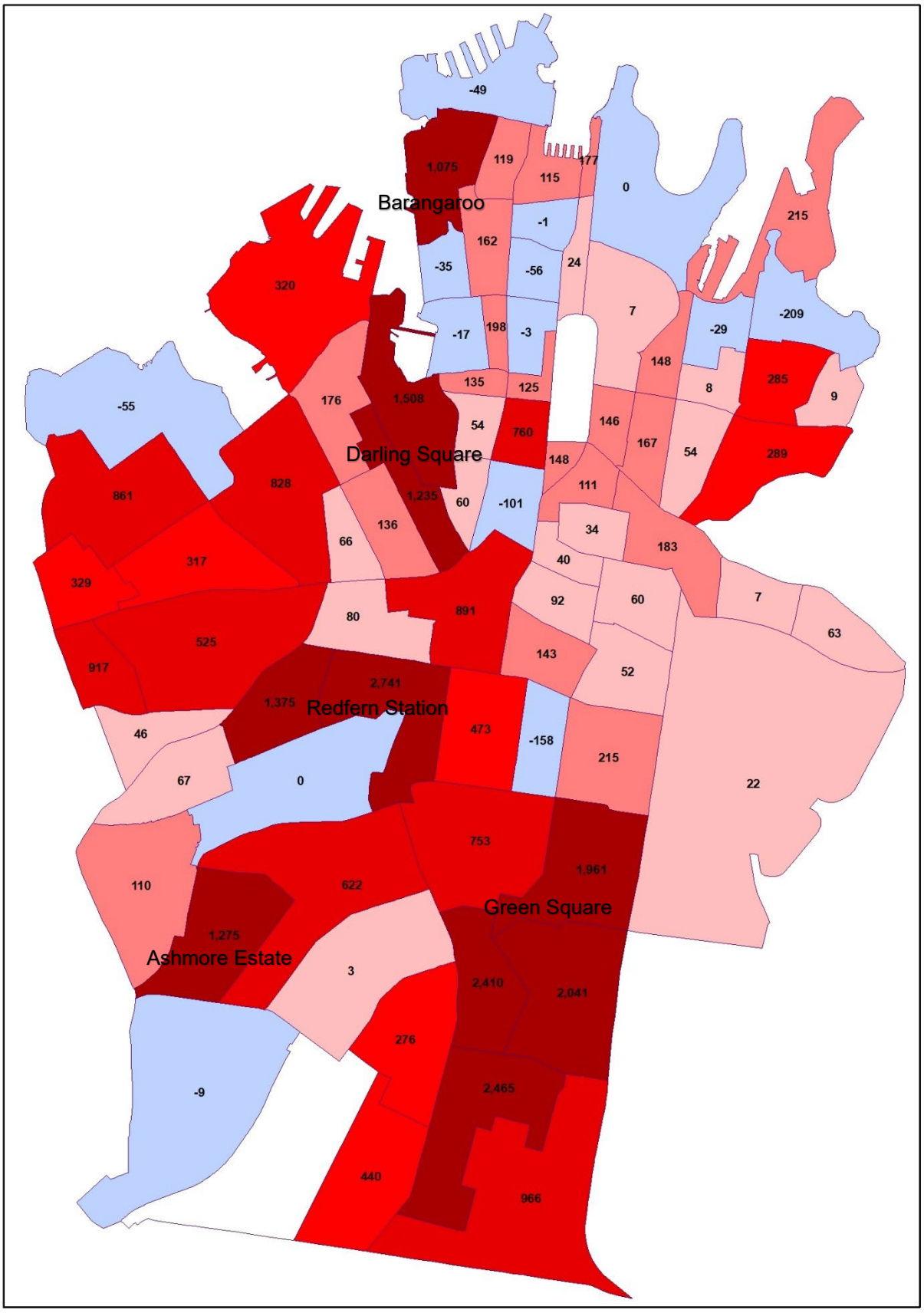


Figure 1. Change in total dwelling numbers between 2015 and 2025

Dwelling tenure

The Housing Data Collection Framework classifies each individual residential unit or residential accommodation room by its tenure type or use. The main purpose of this section is to monitor the amount of social (including public) housing, affordable rental housing, boarding house accommodation and student accommodation in the City of Sydney.

In 2022 the *State Environmental Planning Policy (Housing) 2021* was enacted. The policy changed the definition of boarding houses and introduced definitions for of co-living housing (non-private), build-to-rent dwellings (private dwellings), and changes to the requirements for other types of dwellings.

As of June 2015 (ten years ago), there were:

– 9,800 social (including public) housing dwellings,

– 753 affordable rental housing dwellings,

– 2,941 boarding house rooms, and

– 6,797 student accommodation rooms.

As of June 2025, there were:

– 9,540 social (including public) housing dwellings (down 2.7% since 2015)

– 1,338 affordable rental housing dwellings (up 77.7% since 2015)

– There were 187 diverse[1] housing dwellings, made up of 52 private and 135 non-private dwellings.

– 3,458 boarding house rooms (up 17.6% since 2015), including

  – 1,451 Class 1b boarding house rooms (small dwellings with less than 12 persons) – down 11.0% since 2015

  – 2,007 Class 3 boarding house rooms (larger buildings with higher levels of amenity) of which 87 of these are co-living dwellings (up 51.5% since 2015), and

– 12,924 student accommodation rooms (up 90.1% since 2015).

– 234 build-to-rent apartments. The city's first build-to-rent was completed in 2025.

At June 2025 social (including public) housing comprised 7.6% of the city's private dwelling stock (target is 7.5% of total private dwellings).

At June 2025 affordable rental and diverse housing dwellings comprised 1.1% of the city's private dwelling stock (target is 7.5% of total private dwellings).

Boarding House Accommodation

Over the past 10-years, there has been a net increase of 687 new generation (Class 3) boarding house rooms, and a net decrease of 176 traditional boarding house rooms (Class 1b).

In actual numbers (sourced from the City's development monitoring) there were 895 new generation (Class 3) boarding house rooms built in the past 10-years (in 31 buildings), 72 traditional (Class 1B) boarding house rooms built (in 17 buildings), and 282 (new generation and traditional combined) rooms demolished in 42 different buildings.

Most of the boarding house rooms that have been demolished were low-cost traditional boarding house rooms. The new boarding house developments are generally in different locations to those demolished, and more expensive to rent than those removed from the stock of boarding house rooms.

[1] Diverse Housing is any form of sub-market housing which caters for the housing needs of cohorts which may not be catered for by mainstream housing options, for example Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities, women and children leaving domestic and family violence and LGBTQIA+ communities. Diverse housing may combine support services with housing services or vary elements of service delivery to meet the needs of recipients.

Additional information

The following graph shows the ABS Estimated Resident Population (ERP) for the period from June 2014 to June 2024. The current population of the city is 237,278 residents. The ERP was 16.0% higher in 2024 (237,278) compared to 2014 (204,514).

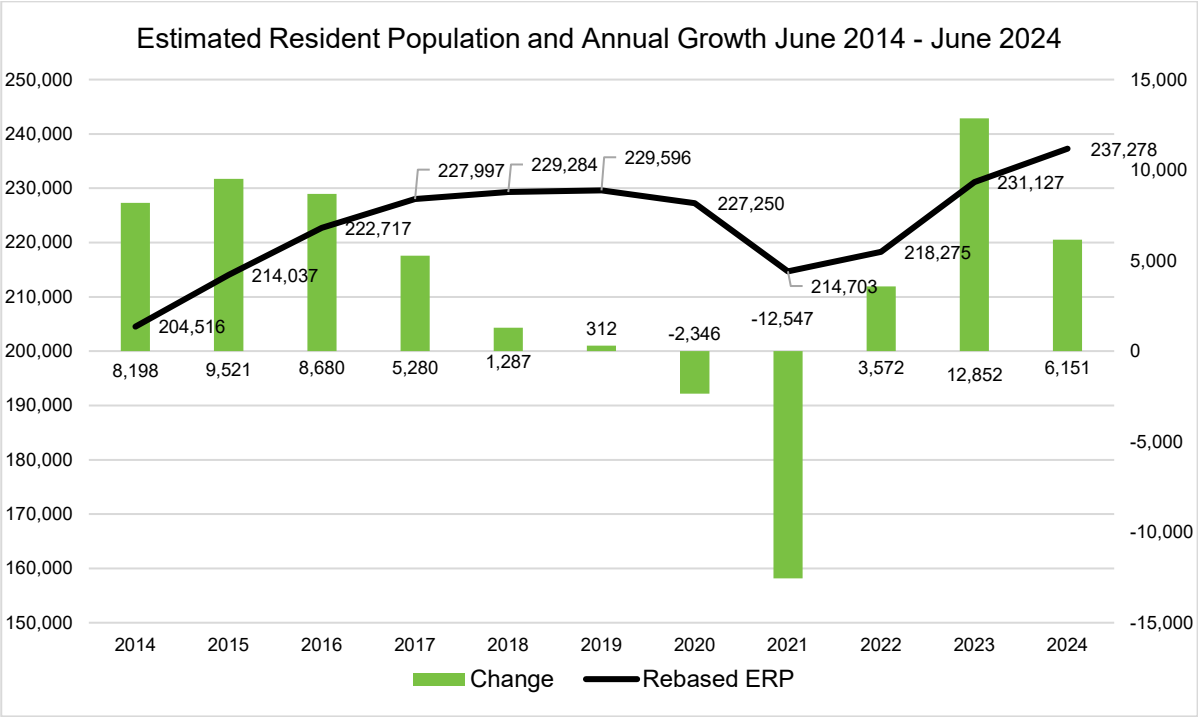


Figure 2. Estimated resident population and annual growth. Source: *ABS Regional Population*

Over the past five years the official population has increased by 7,682 persons. The resident population is now back above pre-pandemic estimates. At the same time 9,190 dwellings have been added to the city's total stock.

Between 2023 and 2024, our local area saw a net increase of 6,151 residents. During this period, 33,105 persons left the local area whilst 13,566 internal/domestic arrivals and 24,731 overseas arrivals settled into our local area. This means that our local area has a total of 38,297 new arrivals over the past year. There was a natural increase of 959 residents.

The Census results showed that the proportion of unoccupied dwellings rose from 11.8% in 2016 to 16.1% in 2021. The next Census is in August 2026.

As of June 2023, the City of Sydney local government area was the 8th largest by population in metropolitan Sydney (7th largest in 2014 using current boundaries).

The ERP was released on 27 March 2025. The June 2025 ERP will be released on 28 March 2026.

The following graph shows the four-quarter average median sale price (in $'000s) for strata and non-strata properties over the ten years from 2014 to 2024. Over this period, the median sale prices of strata properties (predominantly units) increased by 33.1%. Non-strata properties (predominantly terrace houses or separate dwellings) increased by 81.4%.

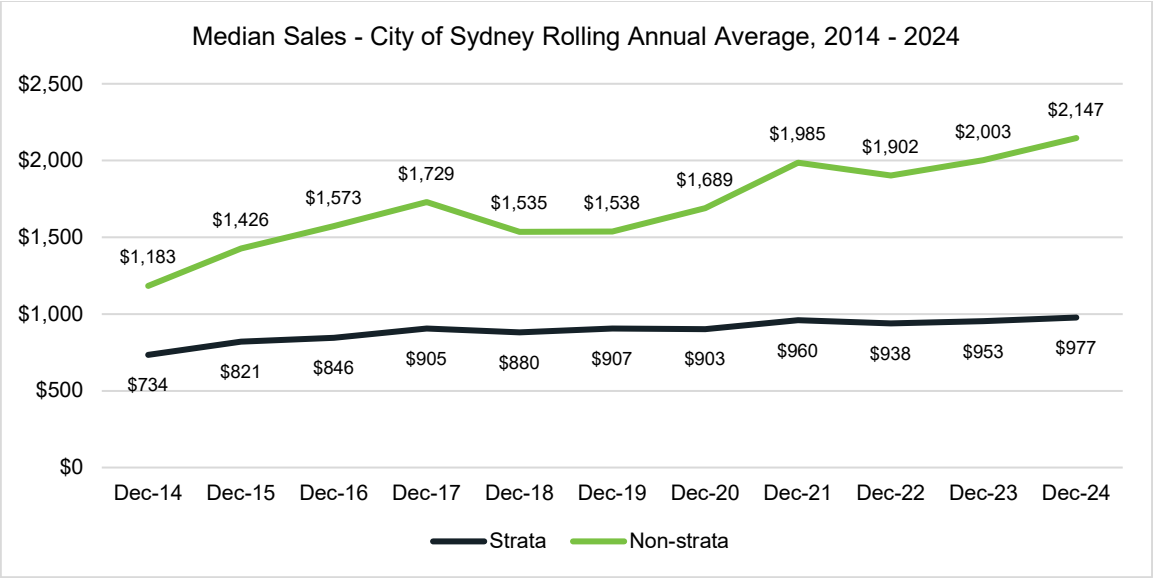


Figure 3. Median sale price, City of Sydney. Source: *NSW Department of Communities and Justice, Rent and Sales Report (Issues 108-151)*

The following graph shows the median rental price (four-quarter average) for new rental bonds of (two-bedroom) units and townhouses for the calendar years between 2014 and 2024. Over this period, the median rental price of (two-bedroom) units increased by 48.1%. Rental prices for (two-bedroom) townhouses increased by 37.5%. Both median rental prices decreased during the Covid-19 pandemic but have risen significantly since then.

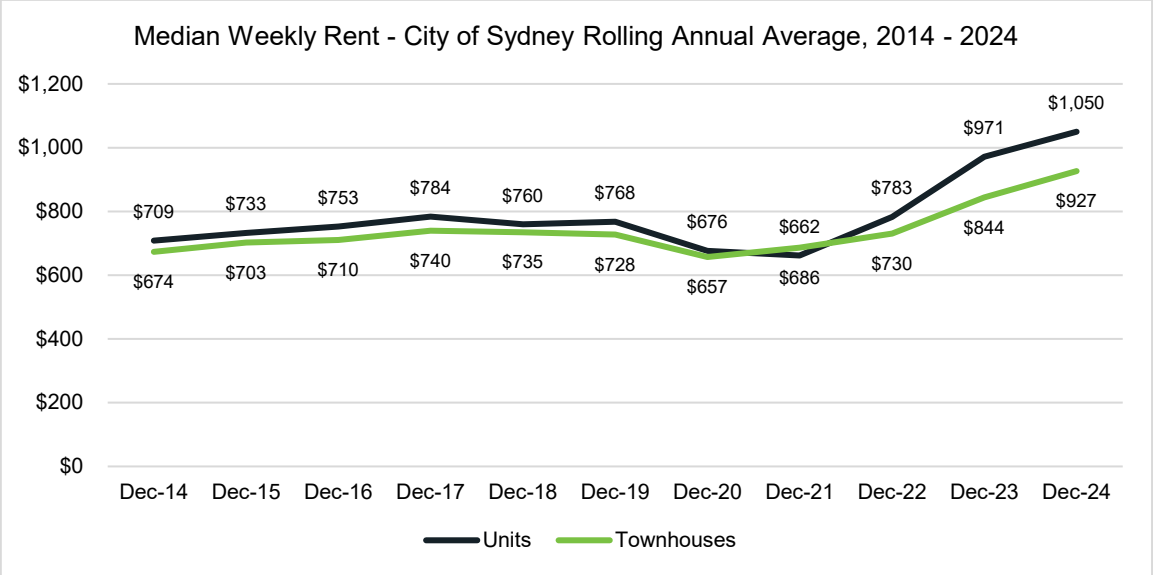


Figure 4. Median weekly rent, City of Sydney. Source: *NSW Department of Communities and Justice, Rent and Sales Report (Issues 107-150)*

Table 4. Selected medians and averages for City of Sydney, ABS Census 2011-2021

	2011	2016	2021
Median age of persons	32	32	34
Average number of persons per bedroom	1.1	1.2	1.1
Average household size	1.9	2.0	1.9

Table 4 shows selected medians from the past three ABS Censuses. The median age of residents in the City of Sydney local area remained relatively stable until 2021, when large numbers of international students and younger people moved out of the city during the Covid-19 pandemic. The flow-on effects have seen the average number of persons per bedroom and the average household size decrease, exacerbating the recent population decline.

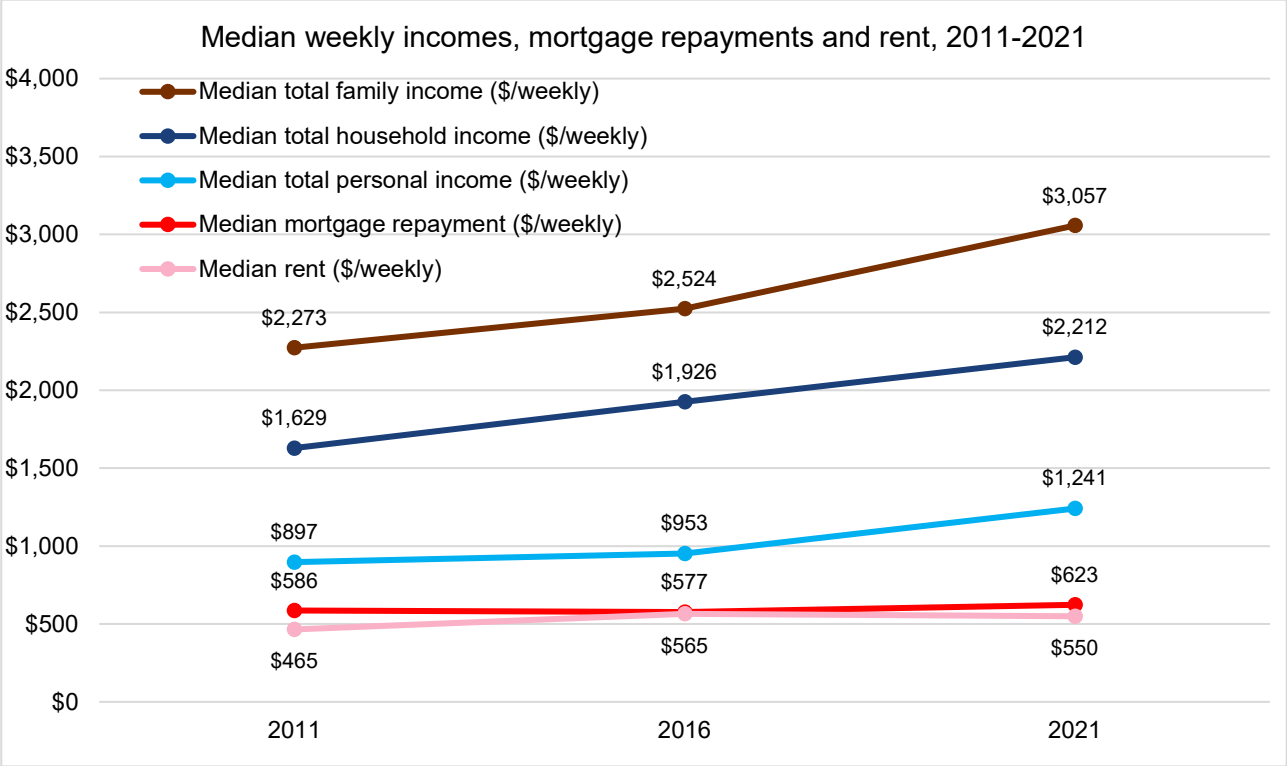


Figure 4. Median weekly incomes, mortgage repayments and rent, 2011-2021. Source: *ABS Census of Population and Housing, 2011, 2016, 2021*

Over the past decade the median personal (38.4%), family (34.5%) and household (35.8%) incomes have risen at a faster rate than median weekly rent (18.3%) and median mortgage repayments (6.3%). Both the median total family income and median total personal income have grown at a faster rate between 2016 and 2021 when compared to the previous five-year period, due to the decline in lower income residents (such as international students) raising the income average for these groups.

Table 5. Proportion of landlord type, City of Sydney, ABS Census 2011-2021

	2011%	2016%	2021%
Fully owned	14.4%	14.5%	14.3%
Mortgage	23.5%	20.3%	19.3%
Renting - Total	60.5%	63.5%	65.1%
Renting - Social housing	9.9%	9.2%	7.3%
Renting - Private	50.2%	54.0%	57.6%
Renting - Not stated	0.4%	0.3%	0.2%
Other tenure type	1.6%	1.8%	1.4%

Table 5 shows the proportions of occupied private dwellings (households) by landlord type for the past three Censuses with the “not stated” category removed. The proportion of occupied private dwellings that are fully owned has remained stable over the past decade, whilst the proportion of households living in their own home with a mortgage has declined.

There has been a commensurate rise in the proportion of households living in private rental dwellings. The proportion of households renting social housing has decreased, whilst the number of social housing dwellings has remained relatively stable over the past decade – they have not risen at the rate of private residential development.

Further information

Additional information relating to residential activity in the City of Sydney local area can be found in the Residential Monitor at:

https://www.cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au/surveys-case-studies-reports/city-monitor-reports

Information relating to City of Sydney local area residents from the 2021 Census and forecasts of future residential growth can be found at the following link:

https://www.cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au/council-governance-administration/community-profile

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Enquiries regarding this document should be made to:

Steven Hillier, Manager Urban Analytics

e. research@cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au

Town Hall House – 456 Kent Street or GPO Box 1591, Sydney NSW 2000

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